4.1.5 Using can-i-deploy to verify that you can safely deploy to production

One of the most important recommendations when integrating consumer contract tests is to ensure you can safely deploy the changes to production. For example, let's say that the consumer has changed their application code. To check that the changes are compatible, the contract tests are run. The provider has verified the new contract, and it's detected that the consumer change isn't compatible! To have a safety mechanism in place, the consumer can use the can-i-deploy command provided by Pact, as part of the contract verification, to confirm that their contract has been verified. In the example shown in figure 4.3, the contract verification failed, which means that they can't deploy the new changes to production. We'll discuss in more detail how to use the can-i-deploy tool in chapter 10.

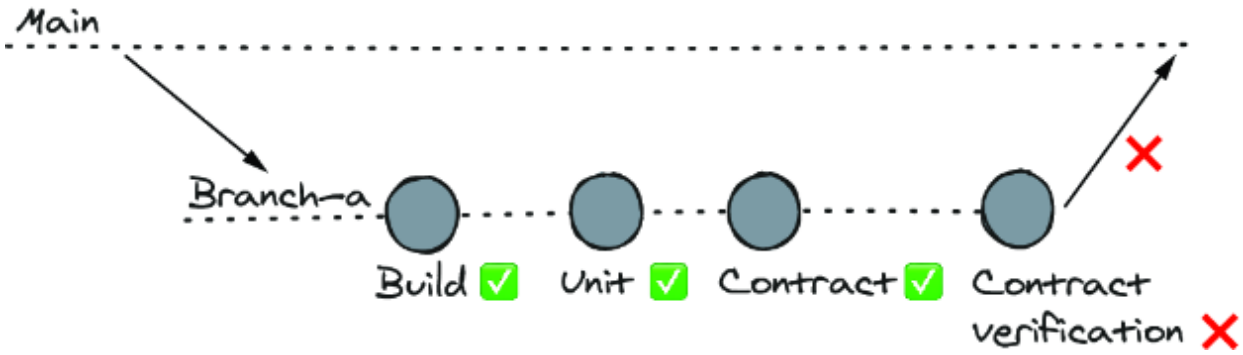


Figure 4.3 Consumer build pipeline with contract verification in place using the can-i-deploy tool

4.2 Contract testing tooling setup for the consumer

As mentioned, we'll use the Pact contract testing tool to show how to start with contract testing because this is the current de facto contract testing tool. Pact supports various programming languages such as Java, JavaScript, Go, Python, and many more (https://docs.pact.io/roadmap/feature_support). This means that if your consumer uses a different programming language than your data provider, which is common in many organizations, you can write the contract tests using the same language as the application code. This provides benefits